Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 30 Months

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For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most children do by 30 months of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your 30-month-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your child has reached by 30 months by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional form

- CDC's free Milestone Tracker mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

Learn the Signs. Act Early. materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most children do by 30 months

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Plays next to other children and sometimes plays with them
- Shows you what she can do by saying, “Look at me!”
- Follows simple routines when told, like helping to pick up toys when you say, “It’s clean-up time.”

Language/Communication Milestones

- Says about 50 words
- Says two or more words together, with one action word, like “Doggie run”
- Names things in a book when you point and ask, “What is this?”
- Says words like “I,” “me,” or “we”

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Uses things to pretend, like feeding a block to a doll as if it were food
- Shows simple problem-solving skills, like standing on a small stool to reach something
- Follows two-step instructions like “Put the toy down and close the door.”
- Shows he knows at least one color, like pointing to a red crayon when you ask, “Which one is red?”

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Uses hands to twist things, like turning doorknobs or unscrewing lids
- Takes some clothes off by himself, like loose pants or an open jacket
- Jumps off the ground with both feet
- Turns book pages, one at a time, when you read to her

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your child do together?
- What are some things your child likes to do?
- Is there anything your child does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your child lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your child have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

You know your child best. Don't wait. If your child is not meeting one or more milestones, has lost skills he or she once had, or you concerns, act early. Talk with your child's doctor, share your concerns, and ask about developmental screening.

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING

Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 30-month-old



As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your child's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your child's development.

- Encourage "free play," where your child can follow her interests, try new things, and use things in new ways.
- Use positive words and give more attention to behaviors you want to see ("wanted behaviors"), than to those you don't want to s example, say "I like how you gave Jordan the toy."
- Give your child food choices that are simple and healthy. Let him choose what to eat for a snack or what to wear. Limit choices to

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Ask your child simple questions about books and stories. Ask questions, such as "Who?" "What?" and "Where?"
- Help your child learn how to play with other children. Show him how by helping him share, take turns, and use his "words."
- Let your child "draw" with crayons on paper, shaving cream on a tray, or chalk on a sidewalk. If you draw a straight line, see i copy you. When she gets good at lines, show her how to draw a circle.
- Let your child play with other children, such as at a park or library. Ask about local play groups and pre-school programs. Pla others helps him learn the value of sharing and friendship.
- Eat family meals together as much as you can. Give the same meal to everyone. Enjoy each other's company and avoid scree tablets, and phones, etc.) during meals.
- Limit screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) to no more than 1 hour per day of a children's program with an adult present. Ch by talking, playing, and interacting with others.
- Use words to describe things to your child, such as big/small, fast/slow, on/off, and in/out.
- Help your child do simple puzzles with shapes, colors, or animals. Name each piece when your child puts it in place.
- Play with your child outside. For example, take your child to the park to climb on equipment and run in safe areas.
- Allow your child to eat as much or as little as she wants at each meal. Your job is to offer her healthy foods and it's your chil decide if and how much she wants to eat.
- Ask your child's doctor and/or teachers about toilet training to know if your child is ready to start. Most children are not able train until 2 to 3 years old. Starting too early can cause stress and setbacks, which can cause training to take longer.
- Let your child play with large boxes. He can pretend it is a car, bus, train, or house. Let him color, paint it, and put stickers on
- Play with your child outside by playing "ready, set, go." For example, pull your child back in a swing. Say "Ready, set...", then say "Go" when you push the swing.
- Encourage your child to name colors, body parts, and pictures in books.
- Kick a ball back and forth with your child. When your child is good at that, show her how to run and kick the ball.
- Have steady routines for sleeping and feeding. Create a calm, quiet bedtime for your child. Put on her pajamas, brush her tee read 1 or 2 books to her. Children this age need 11 to 14 hours of sleep a day (including naps). Consistent sleep times make
- Play "follow the leader" with your child. Walk in a straight line, make turns, walk backwards, and walk on tiptoes. Let your ch after you show him how.
- Read to your child and visit the local library. This will help your child enjoy reading and be ready to read when she is older.
- Encourage "pretend" play. For example, let your child pretend to cook using safe things from your kitchen.
- Show your child how to turn pages in a book or magazine.

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National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

ABOUT THIS PAGE

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